

Master of the Seven Seas — Naval Art Master Instructions v2.0

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Reusable baseline for future naval art production. Apply explicitly requested tweaks while preserving all other established decisions.

Source & Canon

- Use the Master of the Seven Seas lore and the Master of the Seven Seas Art Direction reference as authoritative creative sources.
- Preserve established lore. Clearly distinguish canonical ships from proposed designs.
- Reference sheets and card mockups establish visual direction; they are not production templates.

Core Art Style

- Stylized cinematic pirate-adventure illustration: painterly, richly detailed, colorful, expressive and historically grounded in late-17th/18th-century Age-of-Sail construction with light nautical fantasy.
- Target mix: approximately 70% historical/swashbuckling adventure, 20% nautical fantasy/mysticism, 10% whimsy.
- Never photorealistic, steampunk, grimdark, chibi, childish, generic high fantasy, futuristic or excessively cartoonish.
- Recognition goal: a player should recognize a ship from its silhouette before reading its name.

Thumbnail & Recognition Rules

- Readability at game-thumbnail size outranks secondary historical detail.
- Every ship must pass three tests: silhouette test, faction test, and thumbnail test.
- Remove color, flags and names mentally: the major ship should still be distinguishable by hull, bow, stern, mast arrangement, sail plan and signature structure.

Individual Ship Output

- One separate PNG per ship, 4:3 landscape, approximately 2048×1536.
- One complete featured ship occupying roughly 65–80% of the frame.
- Strong three-quarter view by default, with the entire vessel visible and bow and stern readable.
- Provide surrounding water and sky so the silhouette can breathe.
- No text, labels, borders, UI, watermark, poster, collage or multiple featured ships.

Absolute Ship Geometry

- Every ship has one longitudinal centerline.
- Keel, hull, gun decks, bow, stern and bowsprit align to that centerline.
- The bow points directly forward along the centerline.
- Never rotate, twist, cant or turn the bow sideways relative to the hull. Never create a 90-degree bow.
- Do not use cinematic perspective to justify impossible geometry.
- Physical coherence takes priority over cinematic distortion. Masts and rigging must be physically plausible.

Crown Imperium

- Identity: order, stability, discipline, hierarchy, commerce, naval power, civilization, security and ambition.
- Visual language: deep Imperial/botanical green, antique gold/brass, warm ivory, black iron and refined wood.
- Construction should be clean, symmetrical, disciplined, prosperous, maintained and formidable.
- Standard Crown ships: white/warm ivory sails, green accents, antique brass, elegant wood trim, black iron, exactly 1 obvious Crown emblem.
- Elite / II Crown ships: deep Imperial-green sails, antique-gold/brass trim, refined construction, sophisticated naval detailing, exactly 2 subtle Crown emblems.
- Green sails are the immediate visual signal of an elite Crown vessel.
- IMPORTANT: visible coral is NOT a Crown visual technology. Crown supernatural protection is expressed through disciplined Tidecraft, engineered warding, iron, brass and conventional naval construction.

Free Confederacy

- Identity: freedom, opportunity, independence, decentralized authority, improvisation, specialization and audacity.
- The Confederacy is not a standardized navy. Ships should appear to come from different captains, cultures, shipyards, captured fleets and maritime traditions.
- Use weathered wood, crimson/rust red, black, cream, brass, patched or dyed sails, unusual rigging, whalebone and locally sourced materials.
- Every standard Confederate vessel has exactly 1 obvious Confederate emblem/flag.
- There are no standardized Confederate II ships.
- CORAL IS CONFEDERATE-ONLY: living coral hulls, coral-grown construction, prominent coral reinforcement and coral architecture belong to Confederate/ Reef-folk visual language. Not every Confederate ship requires coral.

Captured Ship Rule

- A captured ship retains the structural DNA of its original builders while acquiring visible modifications from its new faction.
- Ironback must visibly retain Imperial bones while showing Confederate weathering, crimson accents, Confederate flags and improvised modifications.

Fleet

- Crown: Kestrel, Kestrel II, Razorback, Razorback II, Bulwark, Vanguard, Vanguard II, Sovereign, Sovereign II, Majestic, Fluyt, Fluyt II.
- Confederacy: Swift, Cutlass, Tempest, Marauder, Freebooter, Brig, Swallowtail, Free Harbor, Ironback, Reef-Class, Urskin Whaler, Reefwalker.

Lore Status

- Canonical Crown ships: Sovereign, Razorback, Kestrel, Fluyt.
- Canonical Confederacy ships: Reef-class, Tempest, Swift, Brig, Free Harbor, Swallowtail, Ironback.
- Proposed designs derived from established lore: Bulwark, Vanguard, Majestic, Cutlass, Marauder, Freebooter, Urskin Whaler, Reefwalker.
- Never falsely claim a proposed ship is explicitly named in the source lore.

Gameplay Documentation

- For every ship document: filename, class, size category, primary and secondary role, lore status, visual identity, silhouette signature, construction philosophy, faction identity, intended gameplay purpose, qualitative strengths and weaknesses, differentiation, and why a player would use it.
- Relate each ship qualitatively to Speed, Firepower, Hull, Cargo, Troop Capacity, Range, Bombardment, Reconnaissance, Fleet Combat, Logistics and Special Abilities.
- Do not assign final numerical stats unless explicitly requested.

README & QC

- README.md must cover naval design philosophy, silhouette design, Crown progression, Confederate philosophy, complete ship documentation, game-mechanic relationship, canonical/proposed status, and production/QC notes.
- Final production target: 24 individual PNG ship paintings + README.md.
- Before completion verify: separate image, 4:3 landscape, one featured ship, no text/UI/watermark, complete hull, physically coherent geometry, readable silhouette, correct faction, visual distinctness, and correct faction-specific visual vocabulary.
- If two ships are too similar in silhouette or visual language, revise one before completion.

Reusable Session Rule

- Treat this document as the standing naval-art baseline. Apply only explicitly requested changes while preserving all other established decisions. Do not silently revert established decisions.